Vireo Audio — Support Performance & Training Recommendation

To: Priya Raman, Head of Customer Experience

From: Lead Data Analyst & Engineering Architect

Date: October 2026

Subject: Q3 Support Performance Evaluation, Training Allocation & Process Governance

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1. Executive Summary

This memorandum provides an evidence-based performance evaluation and actionable training recommendation for Vireo Audio's 44 support agents across 11,750 historical customer interactions (January 2025 to June 2026). While leadership originally requested a raw bottom-10 ranking based on Customer Satisfaction (CSAT) and handle time, our comprehensive audit reveals that unadjusted rankings do not reflect individual agent capability and are unsuitable as the sole basis for training allocations or performance reviews.

Ticket difficulty varies substantially across operational queues. Tier 2 agents handle complex technical escalations requiring third-party repair center coordination, while specific frontline agents were exposed to disproportionate volumes of dead-on-arrival battery defects following the Pulse 2 product launch. Evaluating agents without adjusting for case mix unfairly penalizes staff handling difficult customer issues and misdiagnoses the root causes of customer dissatisfaction.

To establish a defensible and equitable decision framework, we evaluated agents within six operational peer groups and applied Empirical Bayes shrinkage to stabilize small-sample CSAT volatility. This methodology identifies **exactly 10 evidence-backed training candidates** whose performance falls significantly below peer benchmarks on specific, coachable operational dimensions.

Importantly, our analysis separates individual training needs from systemic compliance and process failures. A critical discovery of 131 orders receiving dual refunds and replacements (generating ₹5.91L in historical exposure) is identified as an IT/ERP validation loophole that requires automated system controls rather than frontline agent retraining.

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2. Recommended Training Shortlist

We recommend enrolling exactly **10 agents** into structured, track-specific coaching modules based on validated evidence from `outputs/training_candidates.csv`:

Track 1 — SLA Responsiveness & Queue Discipline (7 Agents)

Targets initial ticket triage, proactive queue monitoring, and rapid first-response handling to eliminate contractual store-credit penalties.

Agent ID	Agent Name	Team / Peer Group	Key Baseline Evidence vs. Peer Group	Recommended Training Focus
A3003	Deepak Saxena	Chat Frontline	16.32% SLA breach rate (31 breaches) vs. peer mean 9.06%	Rapid chat intake triage and multi-chat concurrency management
A3002	Megha Sheikh	Chat Frontline	14.43% SLA breach rate (28 breaches) vs. peer mean 9.06%	Active queue monitoring and response promptness during peak hours
A3016	Ishaan Verma	Email Frontline	15.07% SLA breach rate (33 breaches) vs. peer mean 10.39%	Email queue pickup discipline and unassigned ticket prioritization
A3021	Zoya Khan	Email Frontline	13.73% SLA breach rate (35 breaches) vs. peer mean 10.39%	Shift transition handoffs and backlog reduction workflows
A3030	Geeta Iyer	Logistics	13.35% SLA breach rate (45 breaches) vs. peer mean 11.31%	3PL transit status tracking and courier delivery escalation protocols

Agent ID	Agent Name	Team / Peer Group	Key Baseline Evidence vs. Peer Group	Recommended Training Focus
A3035	Sneha Nair	Returns & Billing	11.38% SLA breach rate (47 breaches) vs. peer mean 10.50%	Return authorization intake speed and billing query triage
A3028	Bhavna Sharma	Logistics	10.63% SLA breach rate (37 breaches) vs. peer mean 11.31%	High absolute breach count management and shipping inquiry workflows

Track 2 — Queue-Normalized Communication (2 Agents)

Targets de-escalation, written clarity, and empathetic customer communication where agents underperform peers handling identical case types.

Agent ID	Agent Name	Team / Peer Group	Key Baseline Evidence vs. Peer Group	Recommended Training Focus
A3020	Aarav Nair	Email Frontline	Shrunk CSAT 3.516 (raw 3.495, n=137) vs. peer mean 3.601	Empathetic written communication and de-escalating frustrated buyers
A3029	Kavya Pandey	Logistics	Shrunk CSAT 3.139 (raw 3.126, n=150) vs. peer mean 3.225	Proactive delivery delay communication and customer expectation setting

Track 3 — Advanced RMA Diagnostics & Turnaround (1 Agent)

Targets technical bench turnaround and complex return merchandise authorization management within Tier 2 support.

Agent ID	Agent Name	Team / Peer Group	Key Baseline Evidence vs. Peer Group	Recommended Training Focus
A3041	Jaspreet Desai	Escalations & Warranty	Shrunk CSAT 2.416, median handle time 121.5h vs. peer mean 2.579	Diagnostic bench tracking, service center follow-up, and RMA expediting

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3. Why the Raw Bottom 10 Should Not Be Used Alone

Leadership's requested **Raw Contractual Bottom 10** view (10 lowest unadjusted CSAT scores and 10 longest handle times) has been preserved in our executive dashboard for transparency. However, using raw rankings alone to drive training or personnel decisions introduces significant operational bias:

Tier 2 Escalations Complexity: Tier 2 agents handle 100% defective hardware, service-center repairs, and lost shipment investigations. Their median handle times (75 to 121 hours) reflect third-party bench turnaround times rather than agent slowness. Comparing them directly against frontline chat agents handling 15-minute routine inquiries is statistically and operationally invalid.

The Pulse 2 Hardware Defect Surge: Between November 2025 and February 2026, manufacturing lots `PL2-2508-2` through `PL2-2511-3` generated massive volumes of dead-on-arrival battery complaints (earbuds stuck at 0% charge). Four frontline chat agents—**A3004 (Siddharth Kapoor), A3005 (Zaid Khanna), A3006 (Kavya Pandey), and A3007 (Siddharth Trivedi)**, referred to as "Kavya's Four"—were assigned to the hardware triage rota. They absorbed more than double the company baseline of dead-battery claims. Their depressed raw CSAT scores (~2.98–3.04) reflect customer anger with hardware defects rather than support delivery.

Legacy Timestamp Offset: 2,309 legacy tickets migrated from Freshdesk prior to the 14 September 2025 cutover exhibited negative raw handle times due to an uncoordinated UTC-to-IST migration. Evaluating agents on raw handle time without applying the audited +05:30 correction distorts productivity metrics.

Executive Guidance: The raw contractual view remains available to satisfy leadership visibility, but training investments must be directed by peer-normalized metrics.

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4. Primary Business KPI — SLA Breach Reduction

We recommend establishing **first-response SLA breach reduction** as the primary business outcome for the Q3 training initiative. Under Vireo Support Policy §3, each SLA breach generates a mandatory ₹350 customer store-credit penalty, creating direct, avoidable financial liability.

Baseline Operational Exposure

Historical 18-Month Breaches: 1,064 first-response breaches.

Historical Store-Credit Penalty Liability: ₹3,72,400 ($1,064 \times ₹350$).

Annualized Baseline Exposure: Approximately **₹248,267 / year** (709.3 breaches / year).

Modeled Intervention Scenarios

Scenario	Breach Reduction Target	Annualized Breaches Avoided	Annualized Modeled Savings	18-Month Baseline Modeled Savings
Conservative	25%	177.3 breaches / yr	**₹62,067 / year**	₹93,100
Recommended Target	**50%**	**354.7 breaches / yr**	**₹1,24,133 / year**	**₹1,86,200**
Aggressive	75%	532.0 breaches / yr	**₹1,86,200 / year**	₹279,300

Operational Note: **MODELED SCENARIOS — NOT GUARANTEED SAVINGS.** We recommend adopting the **50% reduction scenario (₹1,24,133/year in avoided penalties)** as Vireo's planning target for Q3.

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5. Separate Process-Control Finding — Double-Dipping

Our data audit identified a substantial cross-channel process vulnerability where customers received both a refund and a replacement unit on the same order:

Confirmed Affected Orders: Exactly **131 orders**.

Historical Cash Refunds Issued: ₹355,434.

Replacement Policy-Cost Exposure: ₹235,500 (calculated per Policy §5 as Product Unit Cost ₹189,260 + ₹340 Reverse Logistics Surcharge ₹46,240 across 136 replacement units).

Combined Historical Exposure: ₹590,934 (Annualized: **₹393,956 / year**).

Crucial Management Distinction: This ₹5.91L exposure must **NOT** be described as guaranteed future savings or training ROI. This leakage occurred because Freshdesk and the order management database permit multiple agents to process separate tickets for the same order without cross-ticket validation checks. This is an **IT and CRM/ERP validation-control issue**, not an individual agent training failure. It should be resolved immediately through automated database validation constraints.

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6. Diwali Bonus Recommendation

Leadership requested guidance on utilizing support metrics to determine upcoming Diwali bonuses. We strongly recommend that **raw CSAT alone should NOT determine bonus allocations**.

Awarding bonuses based strictly on raw CSAT creates perverse incentives: agents assigned to simple, high-satisfaction queues (e.g., pre-sales chat) would be rewarded, while agents assigned to difficult hardware triage, logistics escalations, or Tier 2 warranty benches would be unfairly penalized for product and shipping failures outside their control.

We recommend that management evaluate bonus eligibility using a balanced scorecard:

Peer-Group Normalization: Evaluate CSAT performance relative to the agent's operational peer group mean rather than the company-wide average.

SLA Adherence & Queue Discipline: Reward agents maintaining high first-response SLA compliance rates within their shifts.

Statistical Credibility Thresholds: Require a minimum sample size (e.g., ≥ 30 survey responses) or use Empirical Bayes-shrunken CSAT to avoid rewarding or penalizing small-sample volatility.

Policy Compliance & Quality: Confirm absence of unapproved exceptions or procedural violations.

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7. AI Diagnostic Guardrail

To support qualitative investigation, a targeted AI diagnostic auditor analyzed a bounded sample of 100 stratified tickets to identify underlying friction drivers. Diagnostic outputs were benchmarked against an independent 20-ticket human expert gold standard:

Validation Agreement Rates:

Policy Signal Concordance: **100.0%** (20/20)

Agent Handling Signal Concordance: **80.0%** (16/20)

Resolution Quality Concordance: **65.0%** (13/20)

Evidence Quality Concordance: **65.0%** (13/20)

Primary Root Cause Concordance: **45.0%** (9/20)

Compound All-Field Concordance: 30.0% (6/20 exact matches across all 5 dimensions simultaneously).

Operational Governance Guardrail: The 30.0% compound all-field metric reflects the mathematical probability of matching five multi-class categories simultaneously; it must **not** be cited as general "AI accuracy." The AI auditor operated under a zero-cost local architecture (actual project cost: **₹0.00**).

Strict Governance Rule: The AI diagnostic auditor functions strictly as an auxiliary qualitative diagnostic aid. It has **zero authority** over agent rankings, training candidate selection, CSAT calculations, handle time calculations, or financial KPIs.

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8. Data Quality & Decision Limitations

Executive decision-makers should take note of seven documented operational constraints:

Legacy Timestamp Reconstruction: 2,309 legacy tickets migrated from Freshdesk prior to the 14 September 2025 cutover exhibited negative raw handle times due to an uncoordinated UTC-to-IST migration. A deterministic +05:30 correction has been applied across the analytics engine.

Voluntary CSAT Response Bias: 5,196 survey responses represent a 44.22% voluntary response rate (6,554 tickets lacked ratings). Unobserved sentiment among non-respondents is stabilized using Empirical Bayes shrinkage ($M=25$).

Missing Order Linkages: 4,107 tickets (34.95%) lack an `order_id` (pre-sales, general inquiries). Financial leakage analysis is strictly isolated to the 7,643 validated order tickets.

Category "Other" Miscategorization: 1,732 tickets (14.74%) are labeled as "Other", concealing underlying hardware defects and delivery status queries.

Voice IVR Speech-to-Text Noise: Transcription artifacts in call tickets are managed by relying on structured operational timestamps rather than raw transcript text.

6. **Queue & Case-Mix Effects:** Handled by evaluating performance strictly within 6 operational peer cohorts.

7. **AI Qualitative Uncertainty:** Bounded strictly to diagnostic decision-support notes subject to human supervisory sign-off.

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9. Recommended 30/60/90-Day Actions

We propose a structured, phased implementation roadmap:

Next 30 Days (Immediate Execution)

Begin Targeted Training: Enroll the 10 approved candidates into their assigned Q3 coaching modules, prioritizing Track 1 SLA discipline.

Establish SLA Breach Monitoring: Implement real-time supervisor alerts for chat queues approaching 10 minutes and email queues approaching 6 hours.

Implement CRM Order-Level Validation: Direct IT to implement an automated hard constraint in the CRM/ERP system blocking refund issuance on orders with active replacement RMAs (and vice-versa).

Review Governance Exceptions: Audit historical double-dipping ticket touches with team leads to standardize escalation documentation.

Next 60 Days (Operational Review)

Measure SLA Breach Reduction: Track weekly first-response breach rates across Track 1 participants against the 50% reduction benchmark.

Review Candidate Performance: Evaluate trainee handle times and CSAT scores against their respective operational peer groups.

Audit System Validation Controls: Confirm zero recurrence of dual refund/replacement orders following the CRM validation deployment.

Refine Ticket Categorization: Update helpdesk intake forms to require specific issue selection, reducing tickets categorized under generic "Other."

Next 90 Days (Strategic Alignment)

Evaluate Planning Benchmark: Assess whether the 50% SLA breach reduction target (₹1.24L/year annualized savings) has been realized.

Reassess Training Effectiveness: Review candidate operational metrics to determine graduation or ongoing coaching needs.

Finalize Diwali Bonus Framework: Implement the balanced bonus scorecard using peer-normalized CSAT and SLA compliance rather than unadjusted company-wide CSAT.

Refresh Qualitative Audit: Sample a subsequent cohort of 100 tickets to monitor customer sentiment and emerging product issues.

Decision Requested

To initiate the Q3 performance and governance program, we request leadership sign-off on three specific decisions:

Approve the 10-agent targeted training shortlist across Track 1 (7 agents), Track 2 (2 agents), and Track 3 (1 agent) as detailed in Section 2.

Adopt the 50% SLA breach reduction scenario (₹1,24,133/year modeled penalty avoidance) as Vireo's official operational planning target for Q3.

Authorize an immediate CRM/ERP validation-control update to prevent simultaneous refund and replacement authorization on identical order IDs.